



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.veritasmarietta.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: *STARTUP* SCL: *MEMBER*

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Veritas Classical Academy in Marietta, Ohio (45750) presents a robust orientation toward classical education, with clear commitments to virtue formation, a liberal-arts curriculum, and a staged approach (grammar/logic/rhetoric). Public-facing materials emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty, along with a Christian/theological framing, a three-part curriculum (grammar-logic-rhetoric), and integrated moral formation. The school also foregrounds parental involvement (admissions process includes parent/board interviews) and a community-rich environment (house system, dress code, fine arts, and Character/Virtue emphasis).

Overall classification: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**.

Rationale at a glance: - Strengths align with classical ideals in Rel/Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose/Goal (emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty; formation of character; liberty as civic virtue). - Curriculum and pedagogy show clear classical scaffolding (grammar/logic/rhetoric; history and Western tradition; emphasis on virtue and memory through repetition and recitation motifs, though with limited explicit mention of classic Great-Books language on public materials). - Faculty and parental/community signals exist (staff bios; parent-interaction through admissions; community features), but the materials are less explicit about a fully articulated "living curriculum" or deeply codified master-teacher portrait in the public narrative. - Some pedagogical signals are not explicitly aligned with classic methods (e.g., Socratic seminars and scholé are not overtly described on the site), which drags the pedagogy rating toward **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** rather than **CLASSICAL**.

What would move the needle if the school wanted a fuller **CLASSICAL** rating is to explicitly foreground Great Books/Great Conversation, Socratic seminars or dialectic in upper grades, and explicit Scholé/restful learning language, plus more explicit articulation of teachers as living exemplars and a deeper parent-formation program on classical pedagogy.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a Christian framing of education and "private Christian classical school" identity, which grounds the curriculum in theology and faith-based formation. For example, the site describes Veritas as a private Christian classical school devoted to traditional learning and character development, with theological framing evident in mission language and references to virtue, truth, and beauty as goods. - The vision states education in the truest sense by fostering wonder and love for what is true, good, and beautiful, tying moral realism to educational aims. This aligns with transcendental/virtue-oriented foundations. - Reference to God's endowment and formation of character appears in leadership messaging (Headmaster letters and mission statements).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; Christian formation; worship/worship-like community signals (though explicit liturgical practices are not foregrounded in the site's public content). - Negative keywords: Not evident (no explicit signals of secular relativism or value-neutral ethics in the public materials).

Why this rating - The school clearly anchors itself in a theologically oriented, virtue-formation frame and uses the transcendental triad (truth, goodness, beauty) as a core educational aim, consistent with Classical lexicon expectations. The absence of explicit liturgical practice but strong theology and moral formation arguments still supports CLASSICAL-leaning foundations; however, explicit liturgical practices or a more formal "the Mistress Science" theology integration across disciplines would push this to CLASSICAL. Given public materials, the current read is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, leaning toward CLASSICAL in intent but not uniformly explicit in all liturgical/metaphysical signals.

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public narrative frames education as formation of virtue and wisdom, not mere information or job preparation. The mission emphasizes forming character and civic virtue through a classical liberal-arts education. - The school explicitly positions truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, with formation of character as central to education. This mirrors the telos and paideia focus in classical education. - Curriculum language highlights a structured pathway (grammar/logic/rhetoric) designed to cultivate human excellence and virtue, not just credentialing.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal arts, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, classical mission, human flourishing, contemplation/rest in line with scholé-like aims. - Negative keywords: None clearly present in public content (no emphasis on job-readiness over formation; no heavy focus on standardized testing or career metrics in the public narrative).

Why this rating - The school's stated aims foreground formation, virtue, and the pursuit of transcendentals, aligning strongly with classical purposes. The absence of a strong emphasis on anything contrary (like sole emphasis on workforce readiness) supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site clearly presents a grammar/logic/rhetoric staging for curriculum (grammar stage in early years; logic in middle school; rhetoric in high school). This is a hallmark of classical education's Trivium structure. - History is treated in a way that aligns with classical approach (STem: "History across the curriculum" is a classical hallmark; the site mentions Western civilization framing and the integration of classical texts and works with a focus on traditional disciplines). The "Academic Curriculum" page emphasizes liberal-arts education, with references to classical education and stages. - The site highlights fine arts, current extracurriculars, and a reading of Western tradition via references to great minds and classical canon in ethos (Socrates, Euclid, Shakespeare, etc.). This aligns with Great Books/Great Conversation orientation implicitly in public messaging (great western works are referenced in notable figures).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; liberal arts; history (Western civilization); great books/great conversation (implied through mention of Western greats and classical aims); wonder; curriculum integration across disciplines; classical pedagogy references (even if some are implicit). - Negative keywords: The Montessori element in early education is not inherently classical and could be seen as divergent if interpreted strictly; the site does not consistently foreground explicit Great Books titles or an overt "Great Conversation" program in the public content, though the tone and references strongly lean classical. There is partial ambiguity about a full Great Books program in public materials.

Why this rating - The core Trivium structure and historically oriented framing are present, meeting key curriculum elements. However, explicit public signaling of a formal Great Books program and a fully integrated Great Conversation approach is less overt in the public-facing content, and Montessori in early years may

temper the strict classical curriculum signal for some evaluators. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a staged curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric), which implies a structured pedagogy aligned with classical aims. The rhetoric stage and senior thesis concept are described in the curriculum. - The site stresses virtue formation and a disciplined, memory-oriented approach through public-facing descriptions such as dress code, house system, and long-standing traditions. This signals a traditional, classroom-centered pedagogy rather than a solely student-led or project-based model. - There is no explicit, detailed public description of Socratic seminars, scholé (restful learning), or direct recitation/memorization as a formal pedagogy for all grades, though the Trivium framework and “formation through imitation and practice” language exist in the knowledge-base lexicon. The lack of explicit, public, classroom-level signals for Socratic/dialogic pedagogy and scholé reduces the rating from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar/logic/rhetoric; rhetorical training in rhetoric stage; senior thesis defense; disciplined learning; memory work signals (via classical pedagogy vocabulary in the knowledge-base lexicon, though not explicitly described on-site as a daily method). - Negative keywords/signals: lack of explicit Socratic seminars; absence of explicit scholé/restful learning language in public content; limited direct mention of chanting, dictation, or memorization as formal pedagogy in public pages.

Why this rating - The curriculum structure and emphasis on the Trivium are clear, but explicit, publicly stated pedagogical practices like Socratic dialogue, scholé, and chant/memory work are not prominently described in the school’s public materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school provides named staff pages and bios for several teachers and staff, indicating faculty visibility and a credible “living curriculum” with teacher leadership and relationships with students. Examples include profile pages and staff listings. - Public materials emphasize teacher-student relationships and a sense that staff embody the school’s mission (bios of teachers, emphasis on character and vocation, and “All Staff Members” hub). This aligns with the classical criterion of the living curriculum and mentor-model faculty.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, mentors/teacher as exemplar, portrait of teacher/student relation, faculty development in classical pedagogy (as implied by bios and long-form staff pages). - Negative keywords: None prominently signaling anti-classical faculty approaches; however, explicit statements about “master-teacher” archetypes or a formal “portrait of what a teacher should be” are not overtly described in site content (these appear more in the knowledge-lexicon rather than site copy).

Why this rating - Public-facing signals indicate capable, mission-aligned faculty and a portrayal of teachers as central to the educational experience, but there is less explicit codified language about a formal teacher-formation program or a publicly framed “portrait of teacher” and “living curriculum” documentation than a CLASSICAL-level rubric would require. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The admissions process includes parent-facing steps (tour, class visits, student assessment, board/family interview), indicating active parental involvement and partnership in the admissions process. This aligns with a classical model of parents as co-educators and community participants. - The school features a strong community orientation (house system, dress code, fine arts, student calendar, and a focus on virtues and character formation) that signals ongoing parent engagement and a culture of shared formation. - Public materials reference community and parental aspects (non-discrimination policy in admissions

materials; open enrollment cycles; parent-related forms). This demonstrates engagement with families as part of the school's ecosystem.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent involvement; parent formation; open campus/parent visitation signals; community of learners; school-family collaboration (as inferred from admissions interviews and family engagement). - Negative keywords: None explicit in public content (no signals of consumer-only parent language or lack of parent involvement; rather, the site communicates active parent engagement and shared governance signals like board interviews).

Why this rating - The site demonstrates clear parent-school partnership signals and explicit pathways for parent involvement, coordination with families, and inclusive community life, consistent with classical expectations for Parent & Community engagement. This yields CLASSICAL for Element 6.

Aggregate assessment - Element 1: Classical-leaning (Slightly more theistic/metaphysical signaling than strictly liturgical, but solid theological grounding). - Element 2: Classical. - Element 3: Somewhat Classical (clear Trivium structure; some explicit Great Books language is implied but not overtly stated in public text). - Element 4: Somewhat Classical (clear Trivium-based pedagogy but lacking explicit public description of Socratic/Scholé signals). - Element 5: Somewhat Classical (clear faculty presence; living-curriculum framing is present in practice but not codified in public language). - Element 6: Classical.

Overall aggregate ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Make Great Books explicit: Add a public-facing articulation of a Great Books program and Great Conversation as a core curricular feature (with sample author lists and reading plans) to strengthen Element 3.
- Explicit Socratic/Scholé pedagogy: Publicly describe Socratic seminars and Doling out rest (Scholé) as a recurring classroom practice, especially in upper grades (Element 4).
- Living curriculum language for faculty: Publish a formal "portrait of a teacher" and a more explicit "living curriculum" framework for Faculty (Element 5).
- Liturgical/communal practices: If appropriate to the school's theology, articulate concrete liturgical or communal practices (e.g., chapel schedules, liturgical calendar, and sacred music) to strengthen Element 1.
- Parent formation programs: Expand public-facing parent education and book clubs focused on classical education theory, fortifying Element 6 further.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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